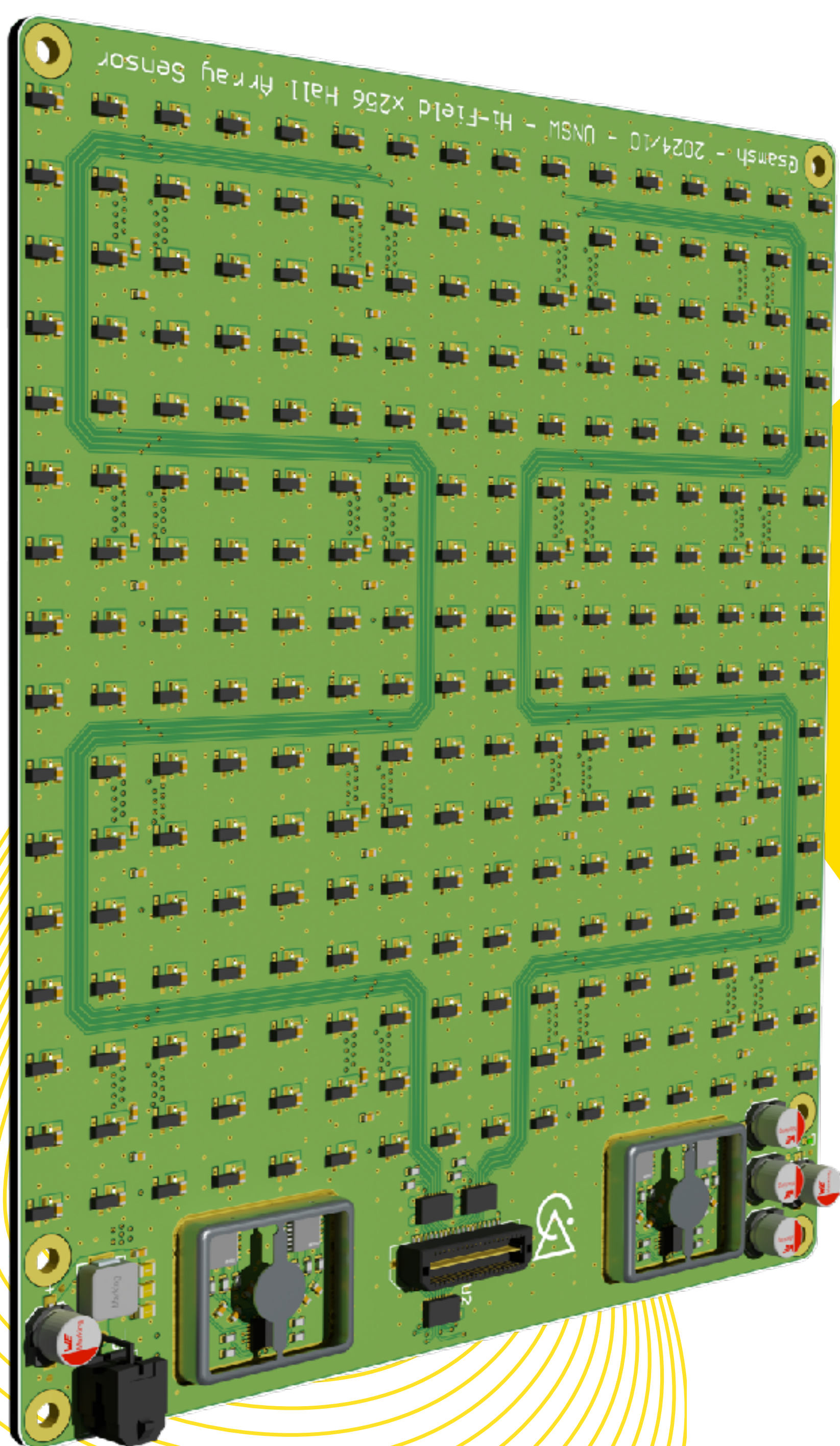


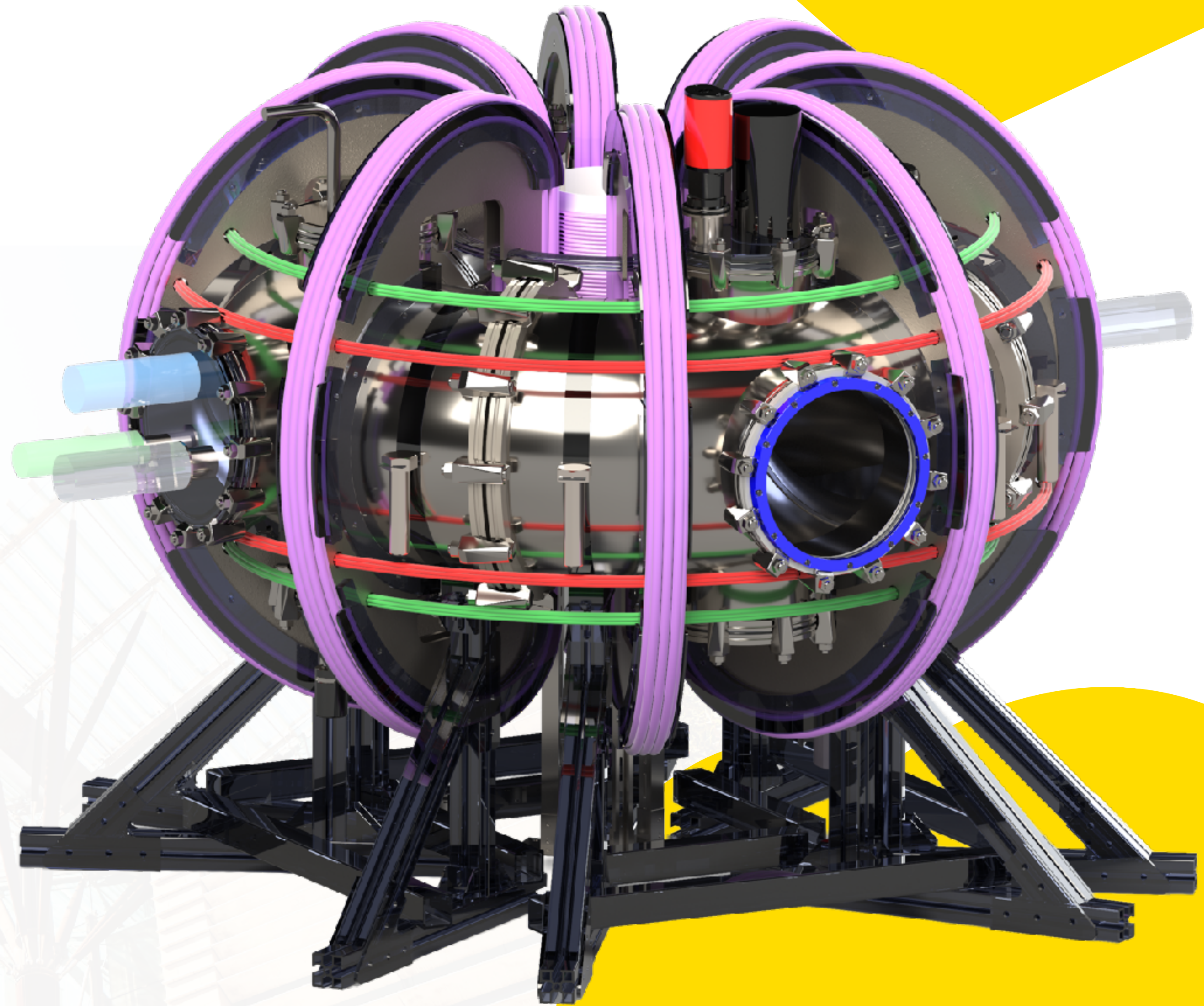


Hall Arrays for 2D Tokamak Magnetic Field Imaging

Sam Shelton, Thesis C Conference
August 2025

The SOUTH Tokamak

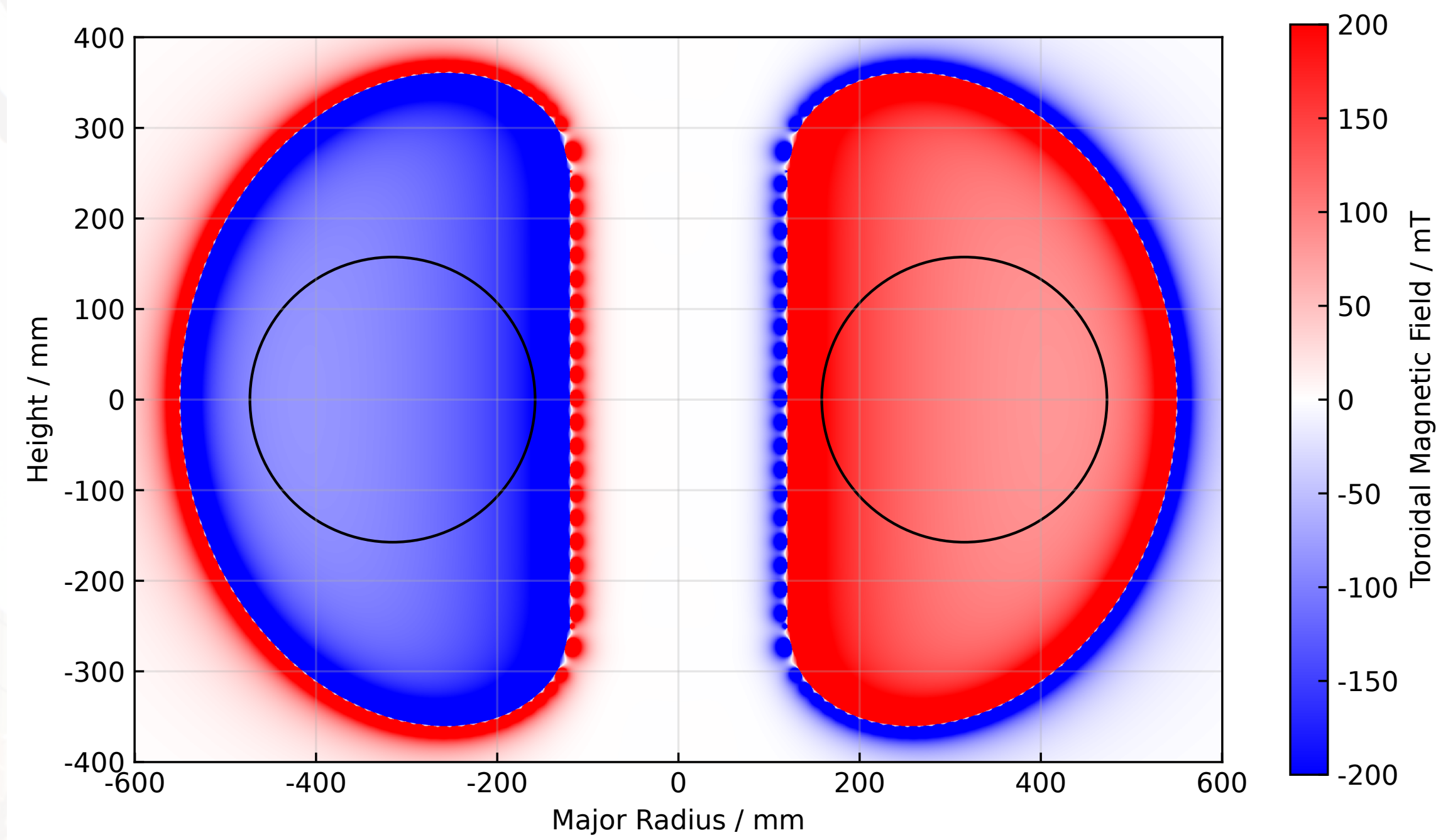
Constructed as part of the ATOMCRAFT vertically integrated project, the Student Operated Undergraduate Tokamak for Hydrogen (SOUTH) will be the worlds first fusion device of its class designed and built by undergraduates when it is switch on in late 2026.



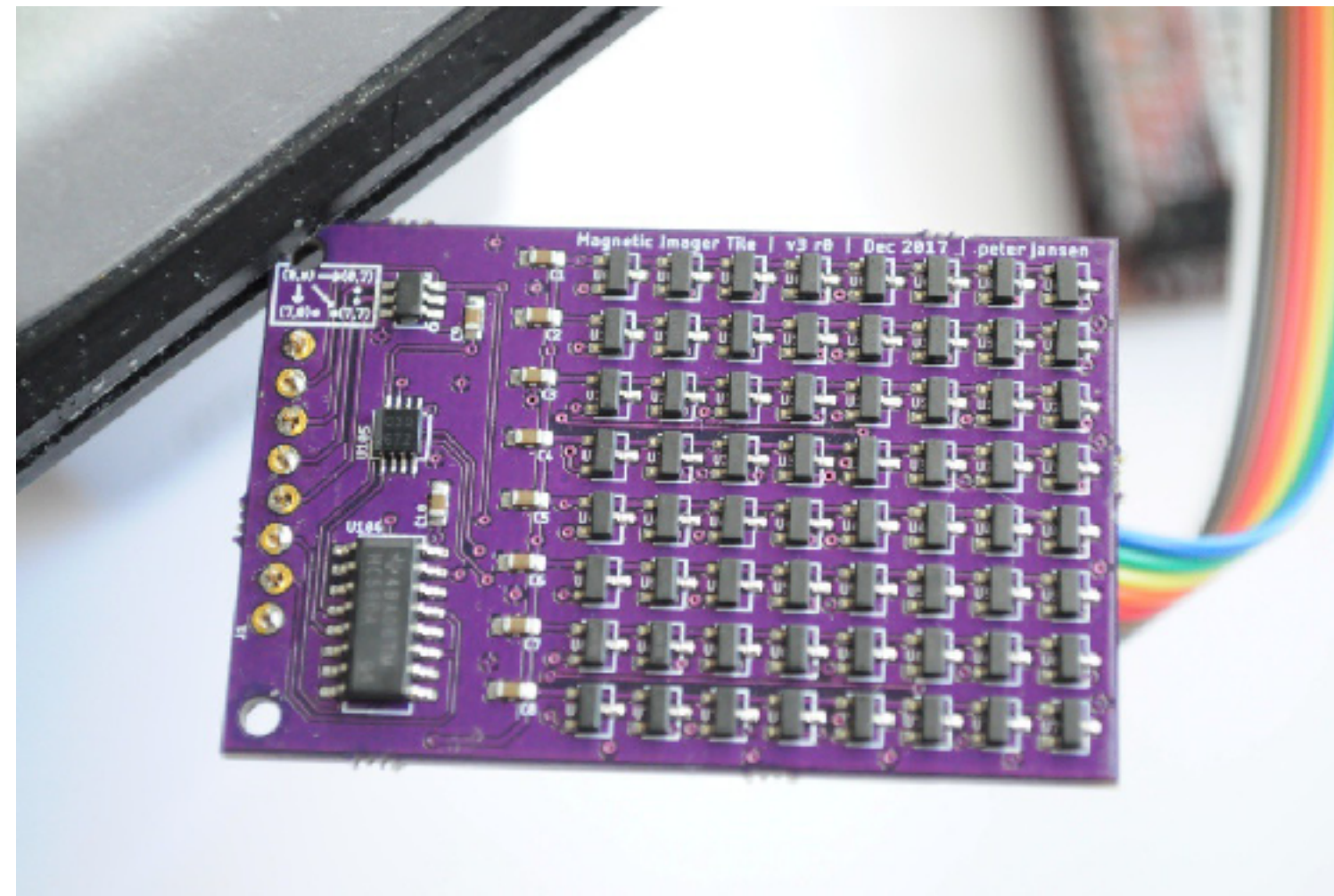


Aims

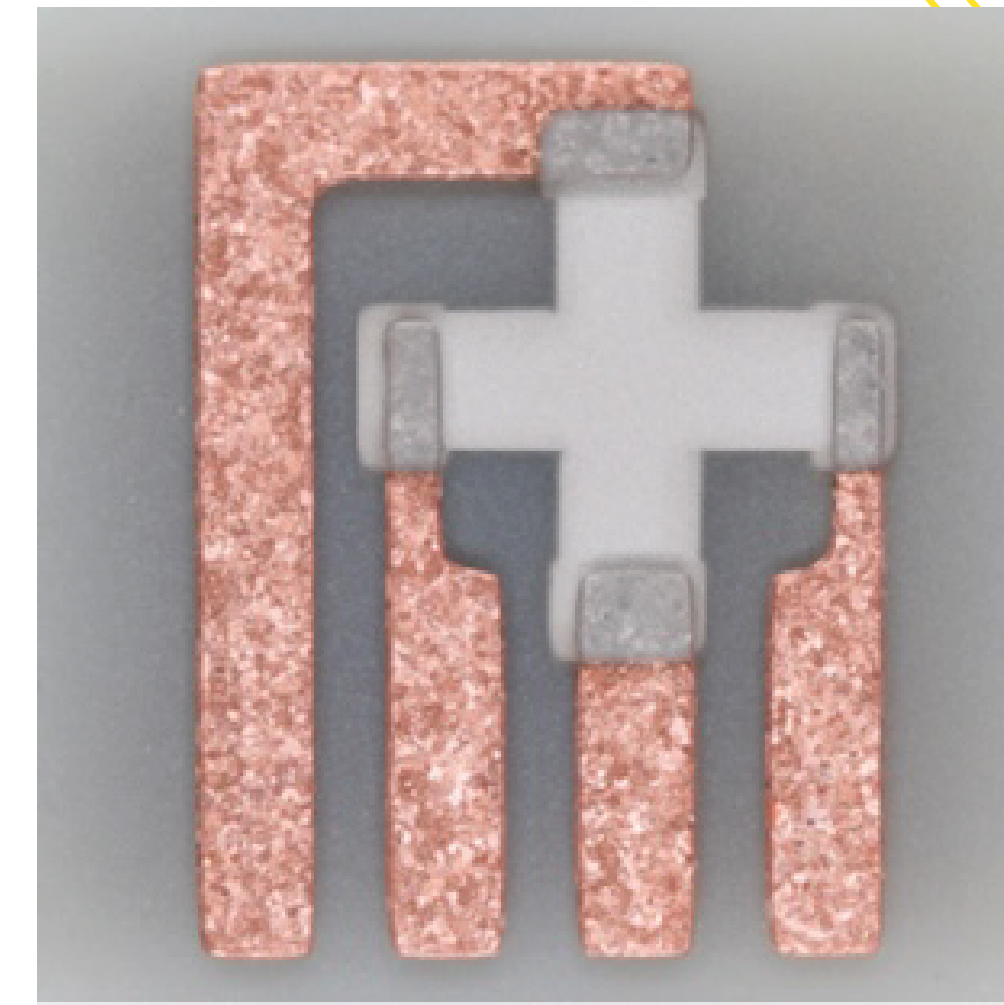
- We need a device to **monitor the toroidal field** to make sure SOUTH will actually work
- **De-risk** the R&D and manufacturing process



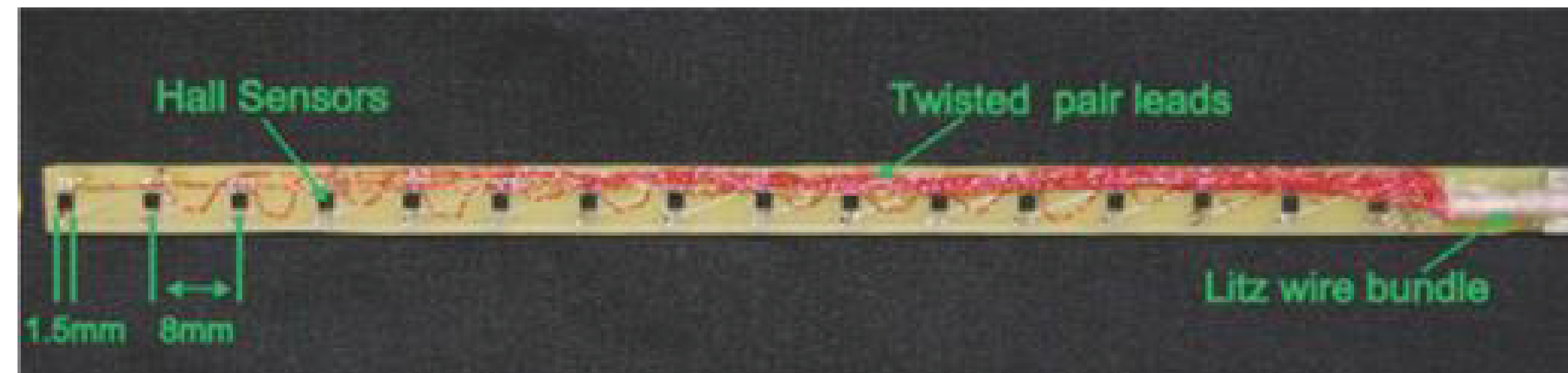
Existing Solutions



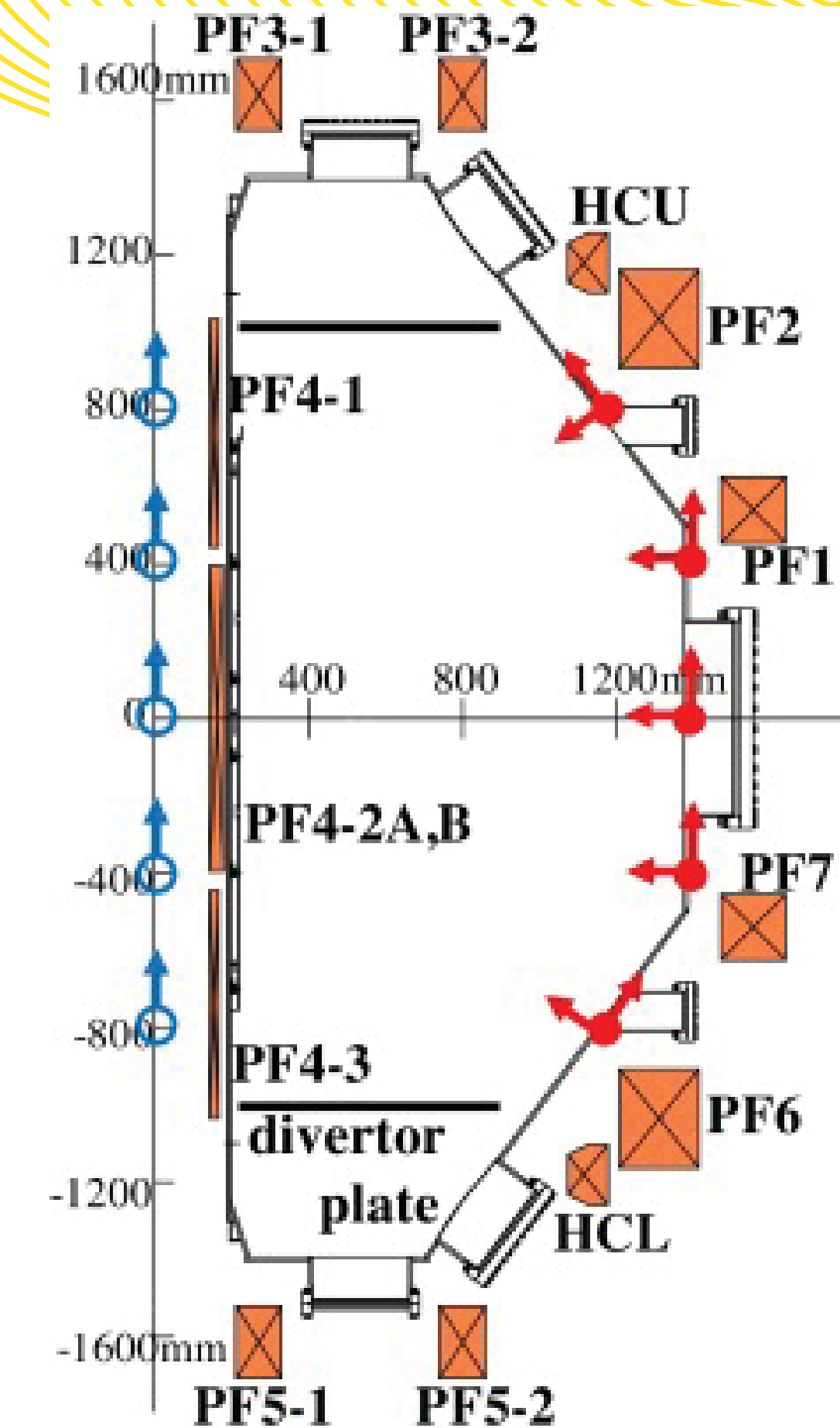
Jansen¹: educational tool, too slow and no filtering or buffering



Dûran²: single, radiation hardened sensor for ITER



Stevenson³: Insertable 1D poloidal array with commercial sensors



Hasegawa⁴: QUEST probe locations

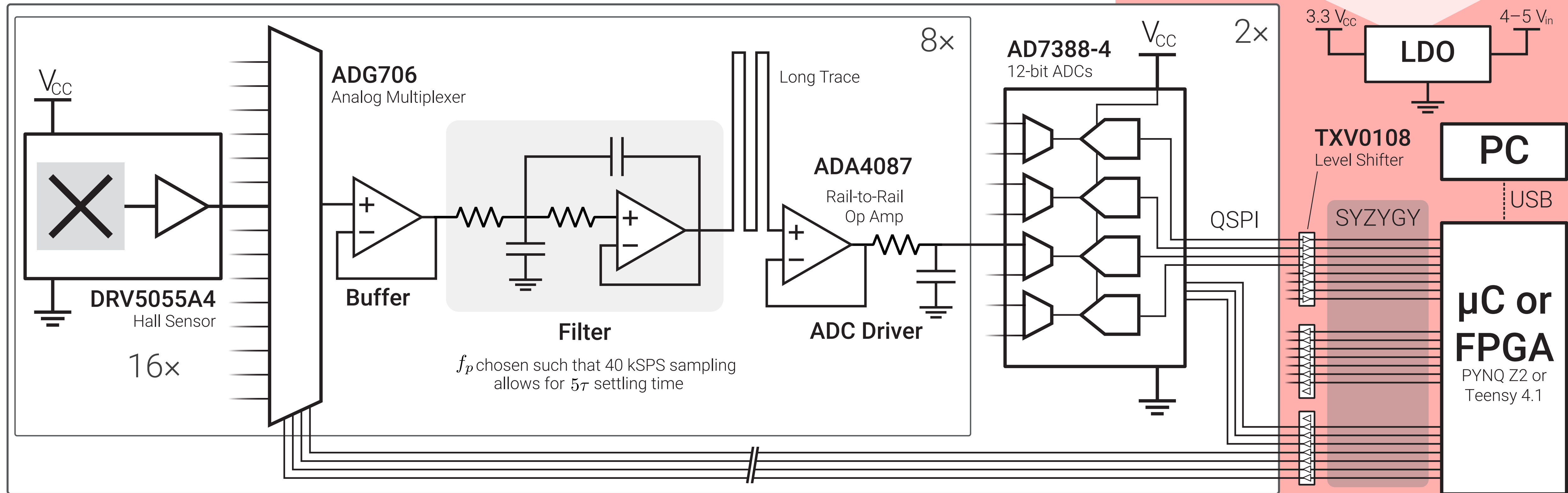
Design Requirements specific **for fusion** and use in **SOUTH**:

- **High Bandwidth** to monitor the dynamic field, >10 kHz is *desirable*
- **High Sensitivity** to catch stray field fields, >1 mT is *desirable*—**EMI resistance**
- **High Dynamic Range** to monitor large fields, $>\pm 150$ mT *required*
- Must **fit inside SOUTH** through its flange with width of 150 mm

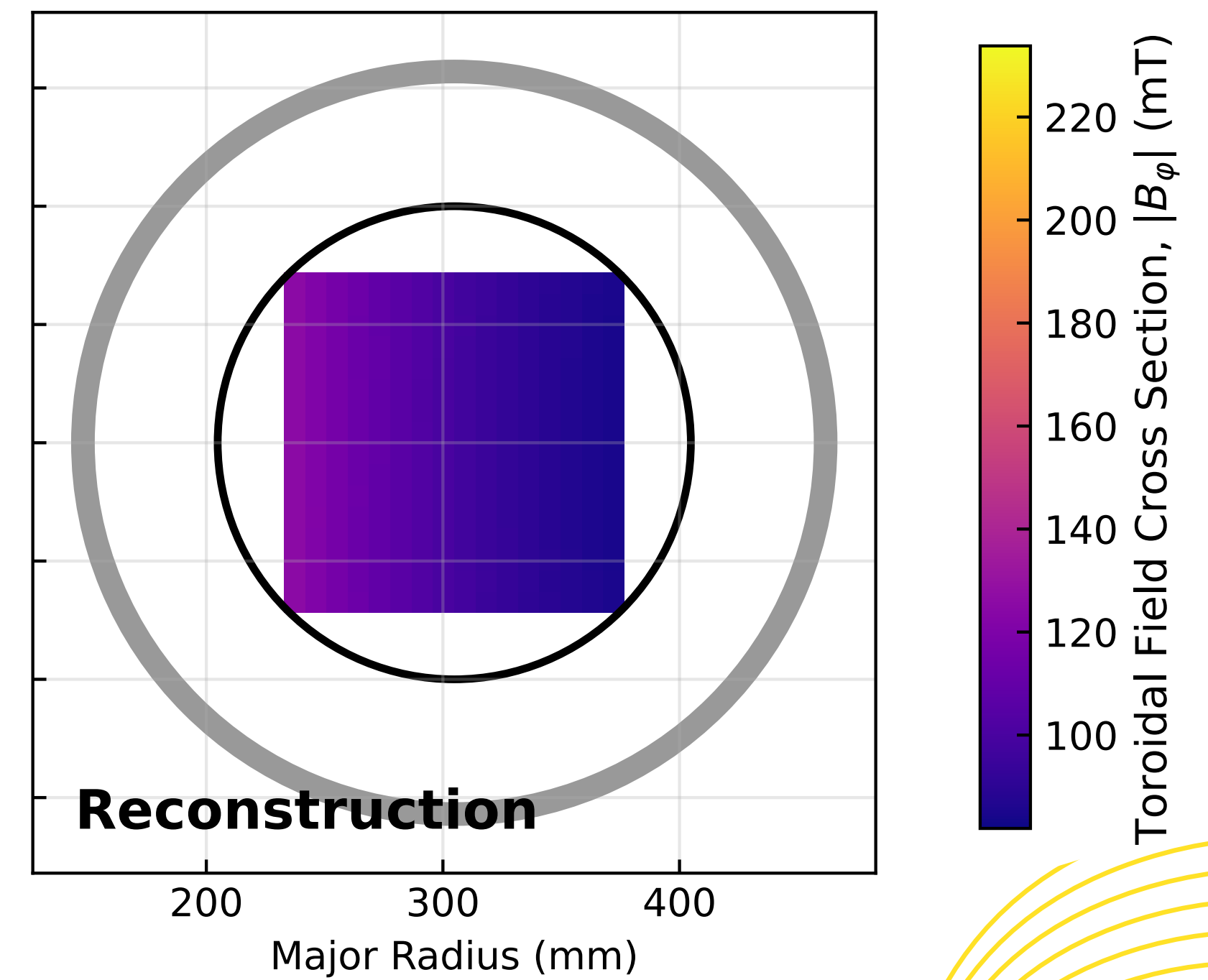
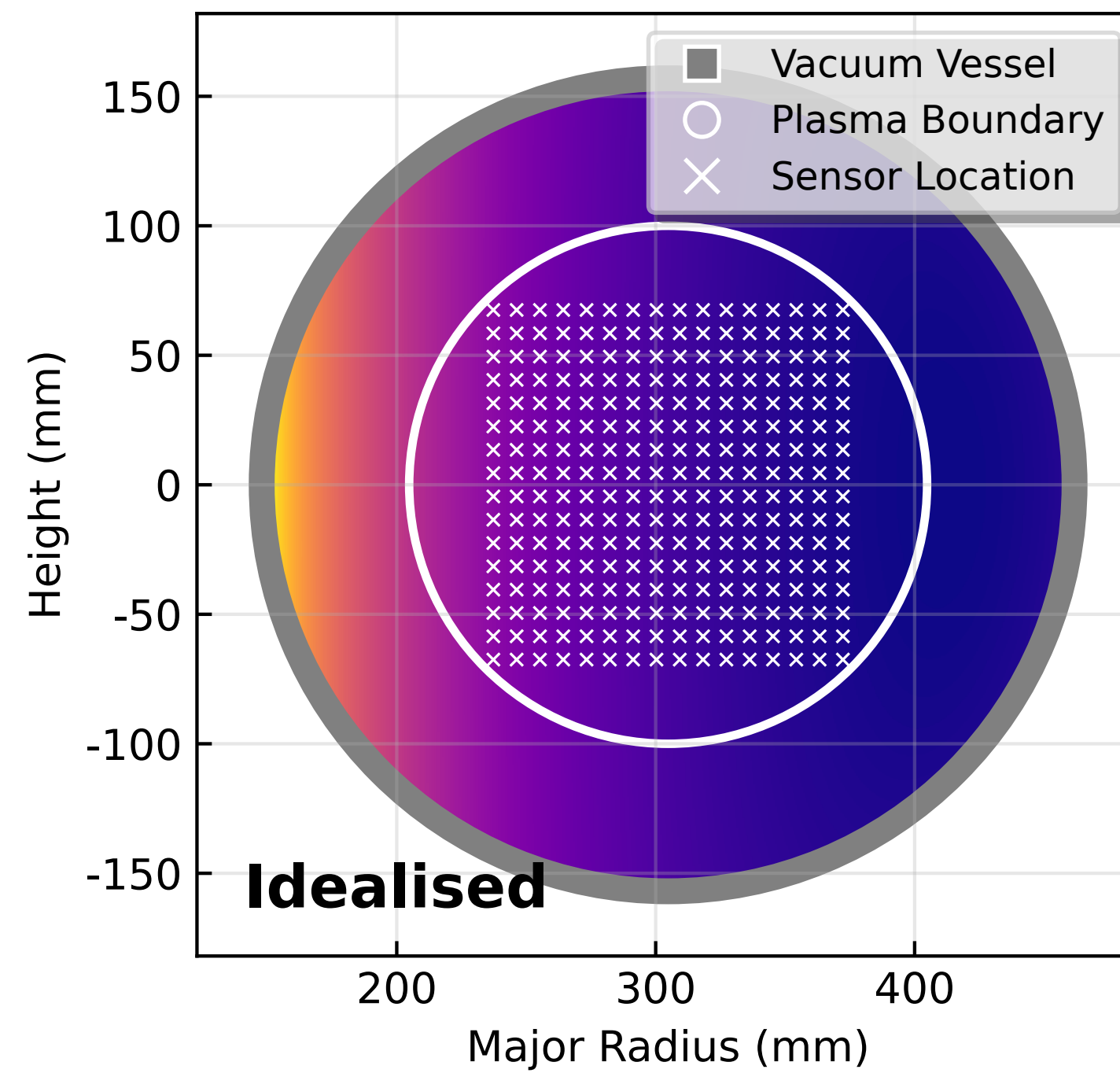
An architecture optimised for **low noise** with **20 kHz** of bandwidth

- 256 sensors in 16x16 grid arranged with 9 mm sensor pitch
- Multiplexed topology: 16:1 into filters, 2:1 into ADC inputs. 2 Discrete ADC ICs with 8 actual silicon ADCs total
- Second-order Sallen-Key filter, plus buffer and ADC driver
- Shared voltage reference across all sensors
- External connection to digital controller (either μC or an FPGA)

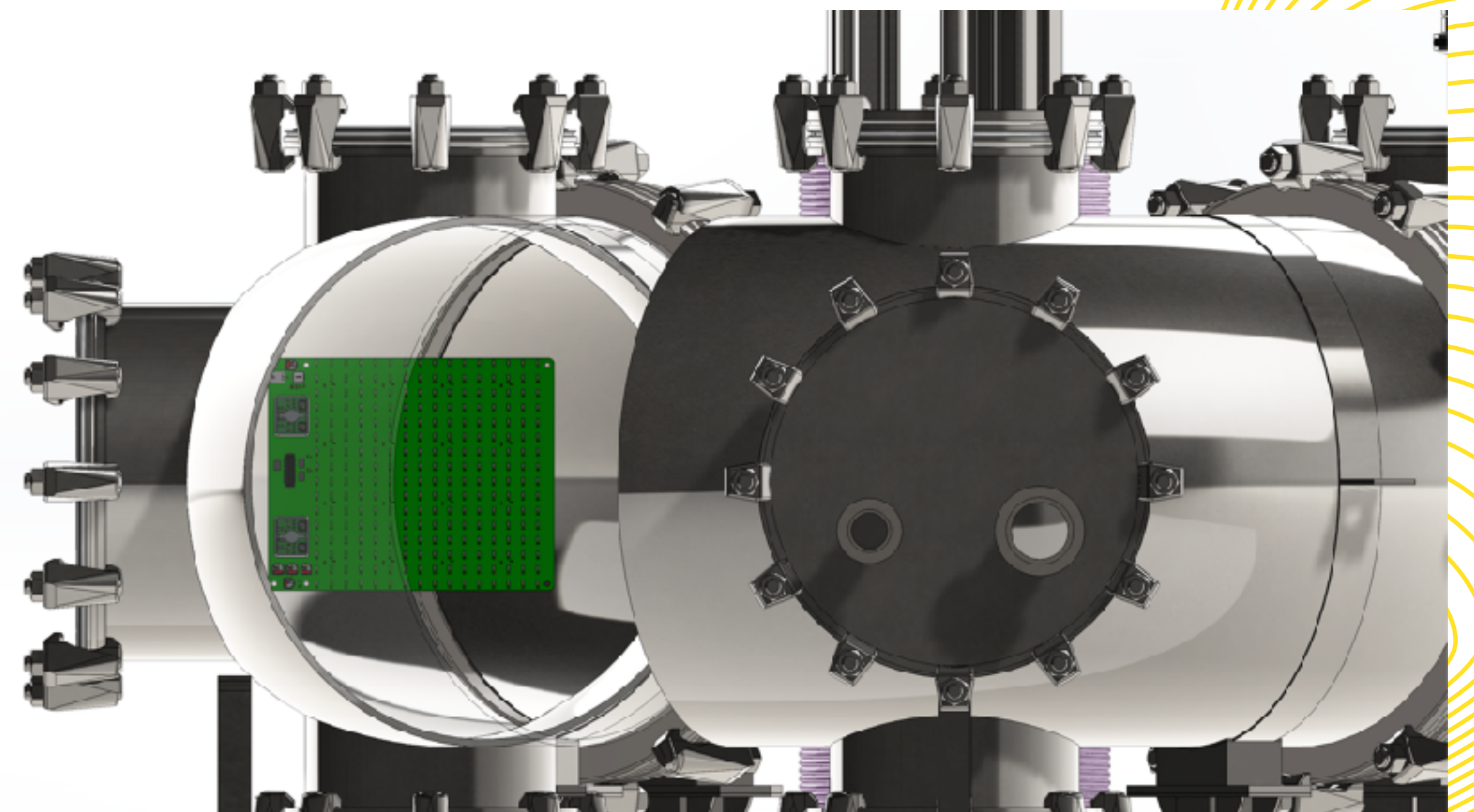
Device Methodology



Device Methodology



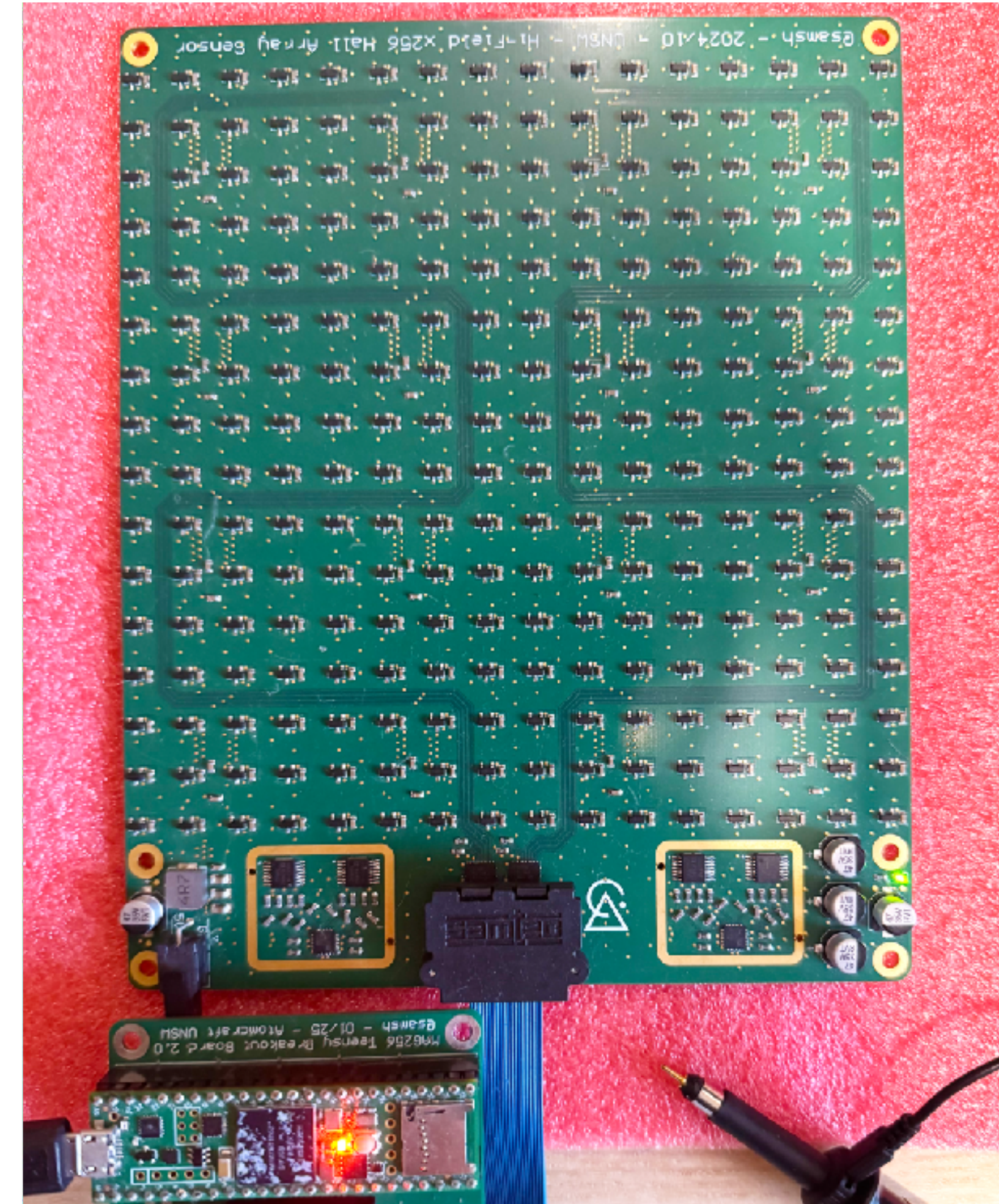
A simulated
**toroidal field
reconstruction**
and experimental
configuration



Results

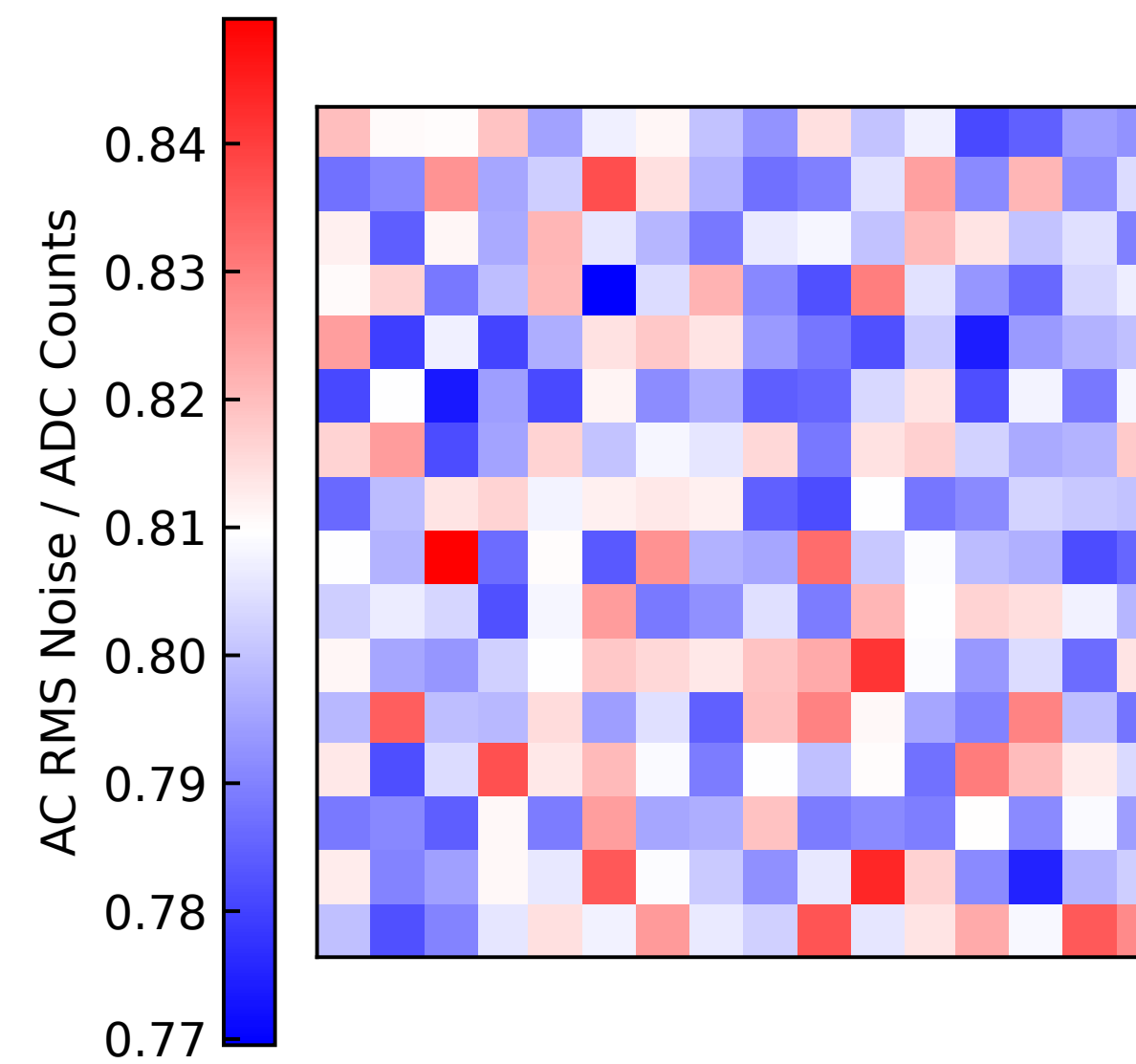
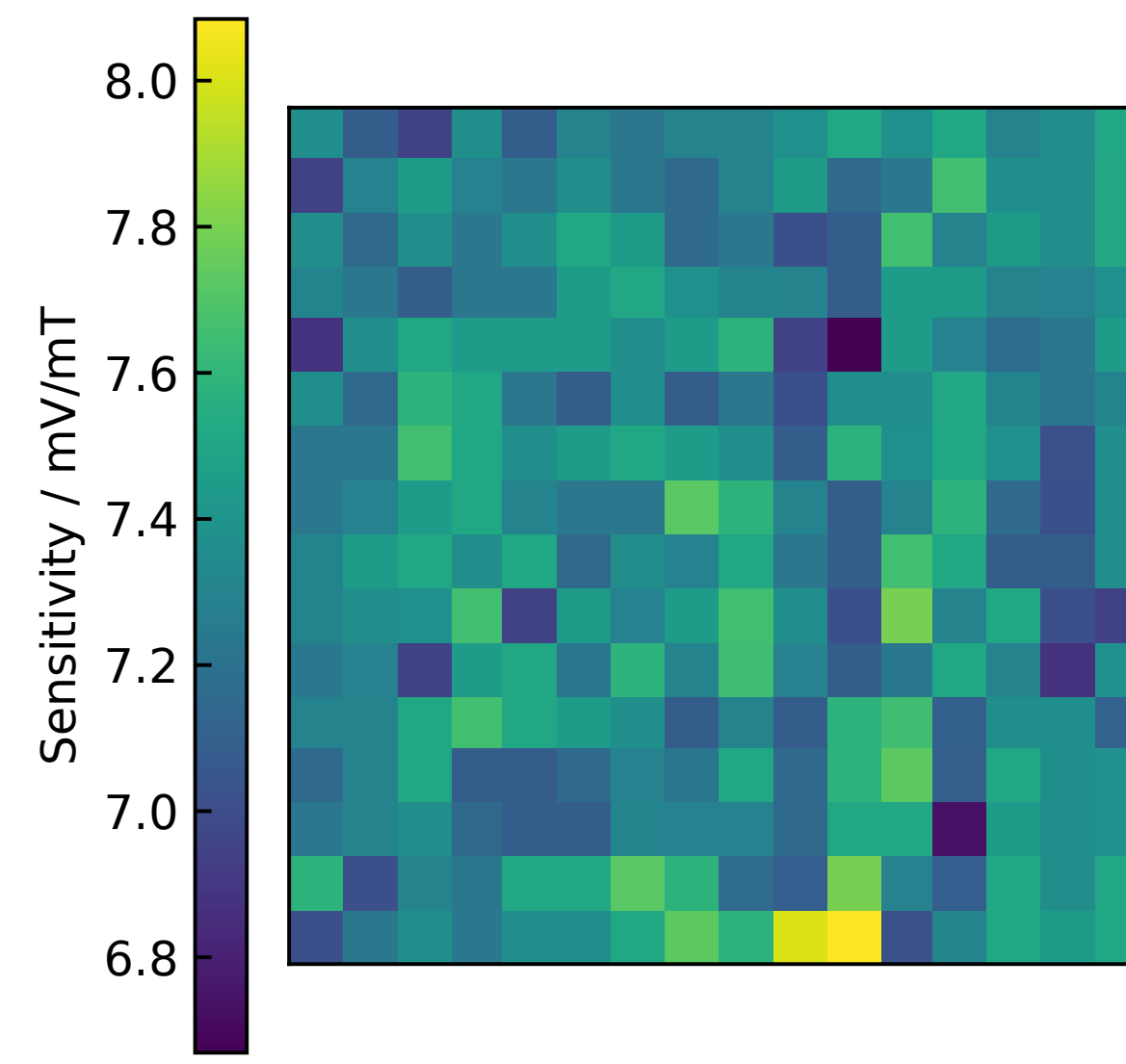
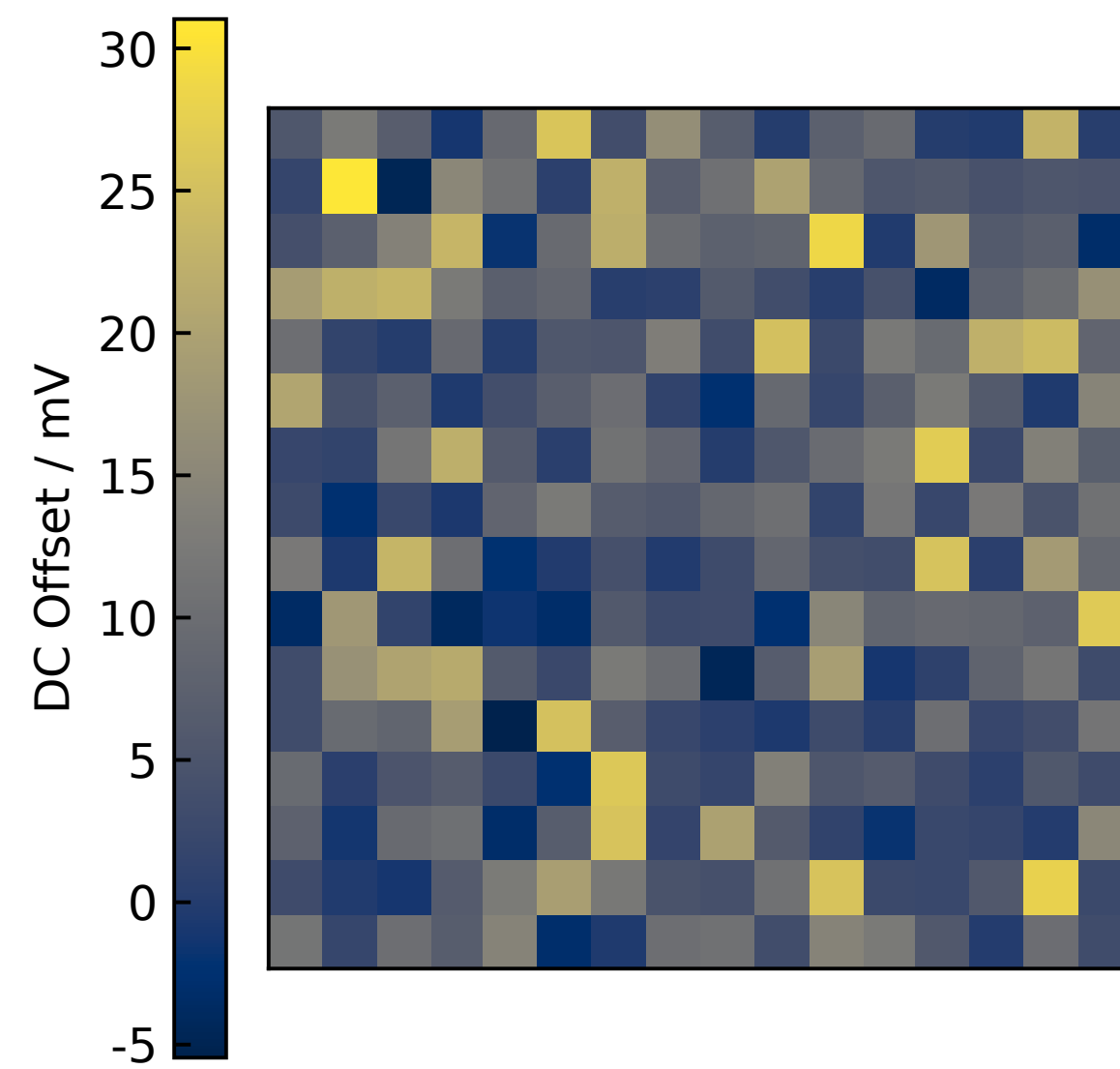
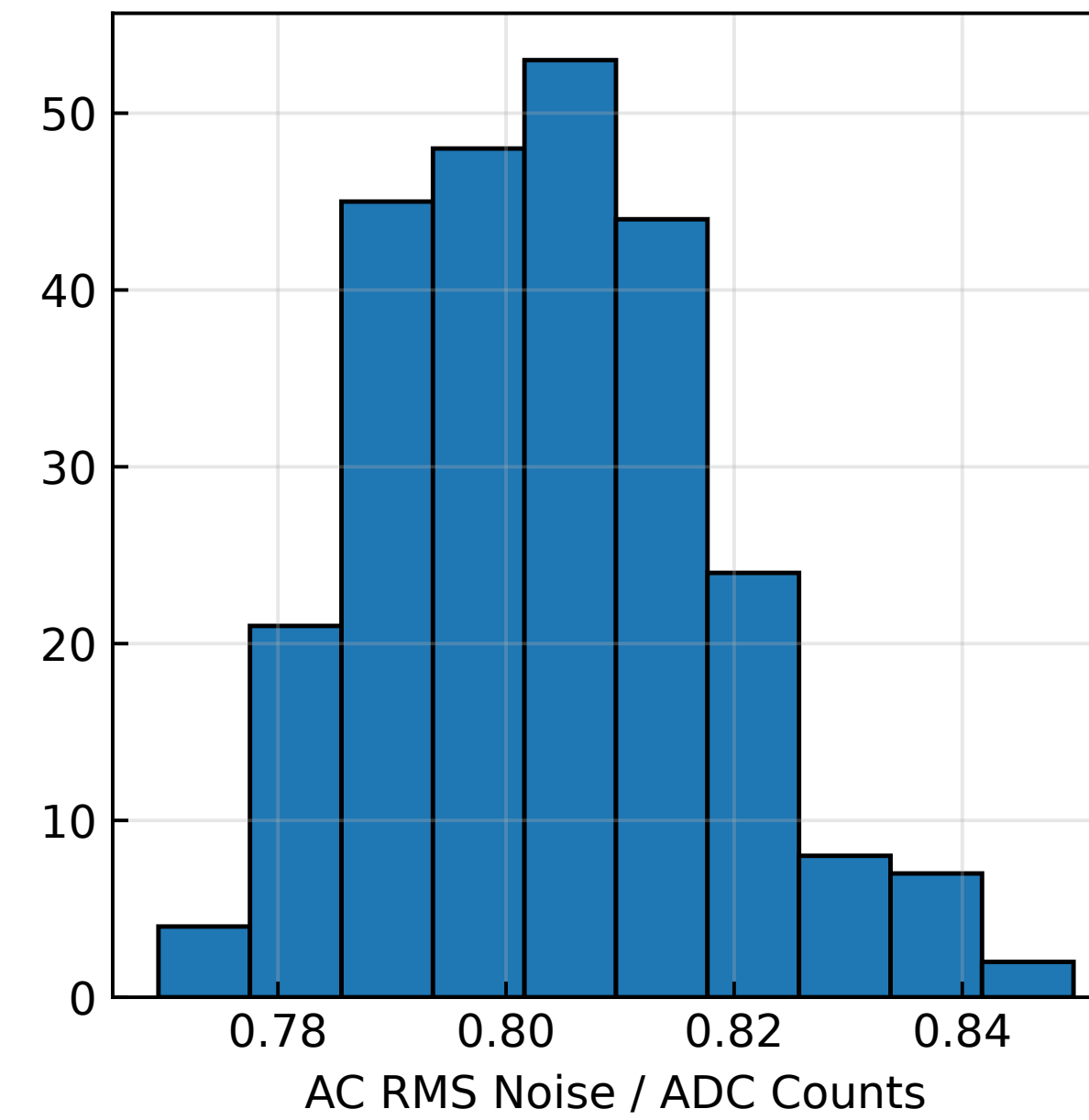
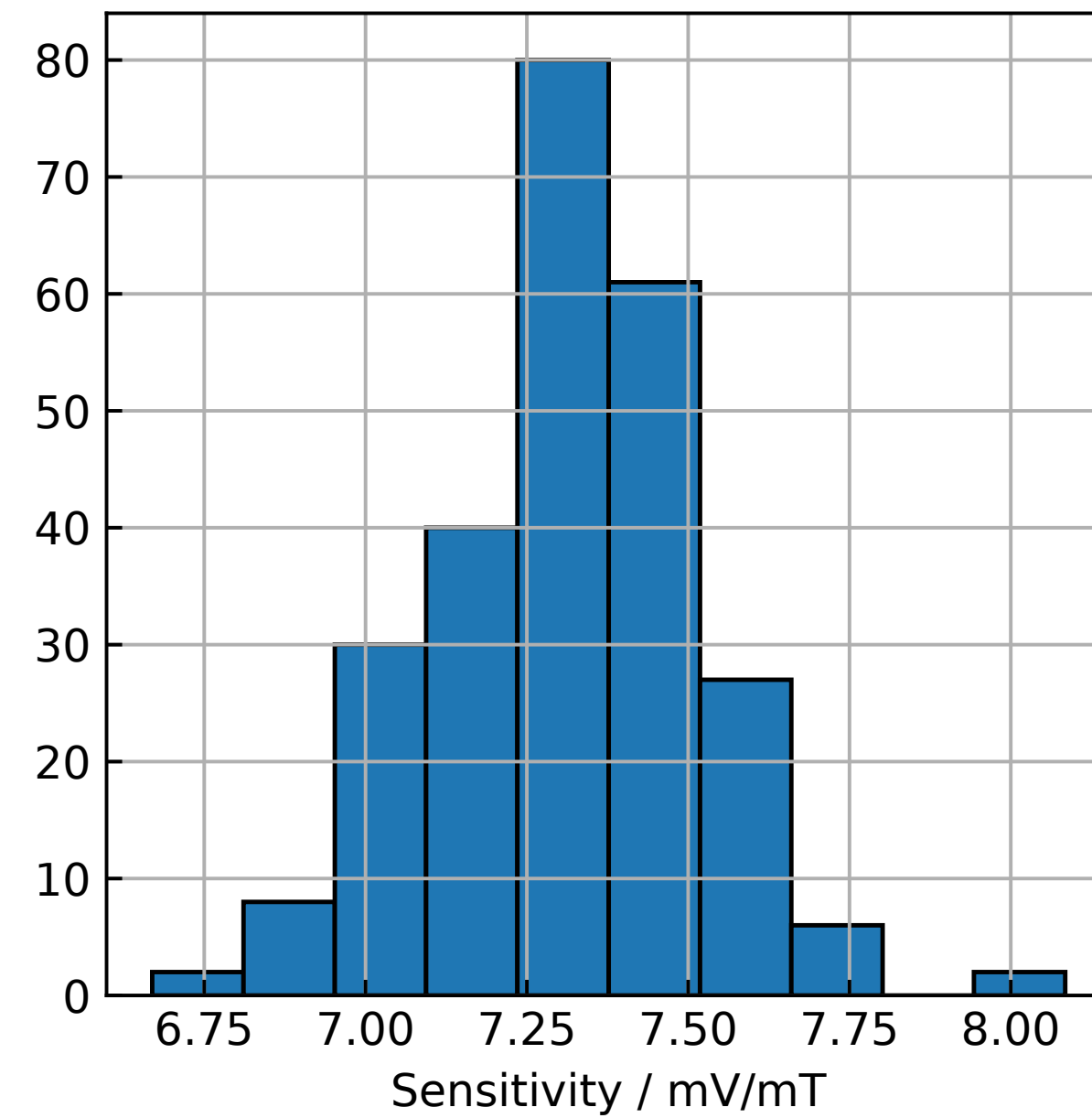
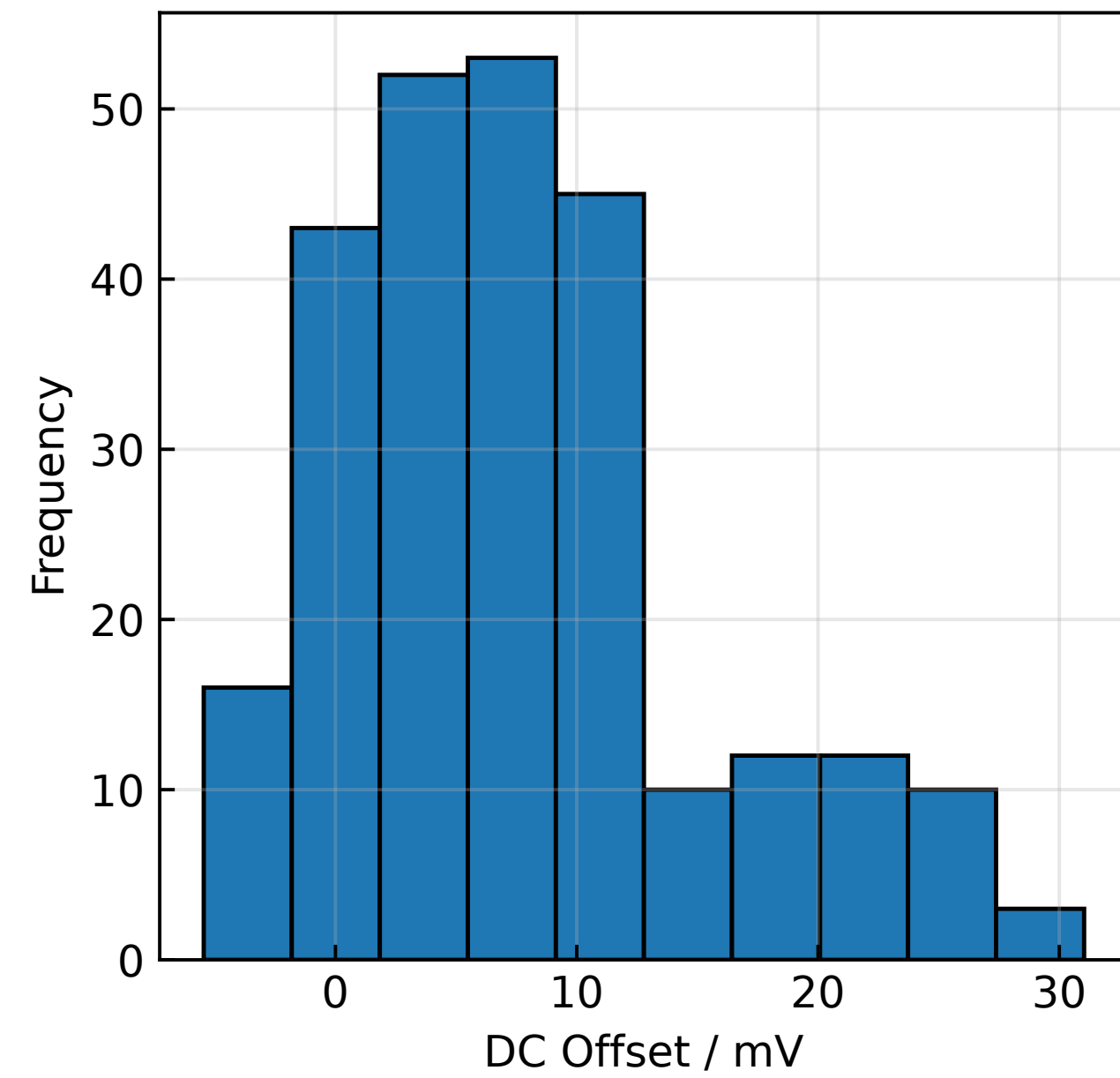
Specifications

Sensor Layout	16×16, 9mm Pitch
Dimensions.....	175×142 mm
Dynamic Range.....	>±150 mT
Bandwidth	20 kHz
Sampling	>40 kSPS/sensor
Sensitivity.....	0.32 mT
Bits.....	12, ~10.4 ENOB
Number of Components	>600
Power Consumption	~7.5 W



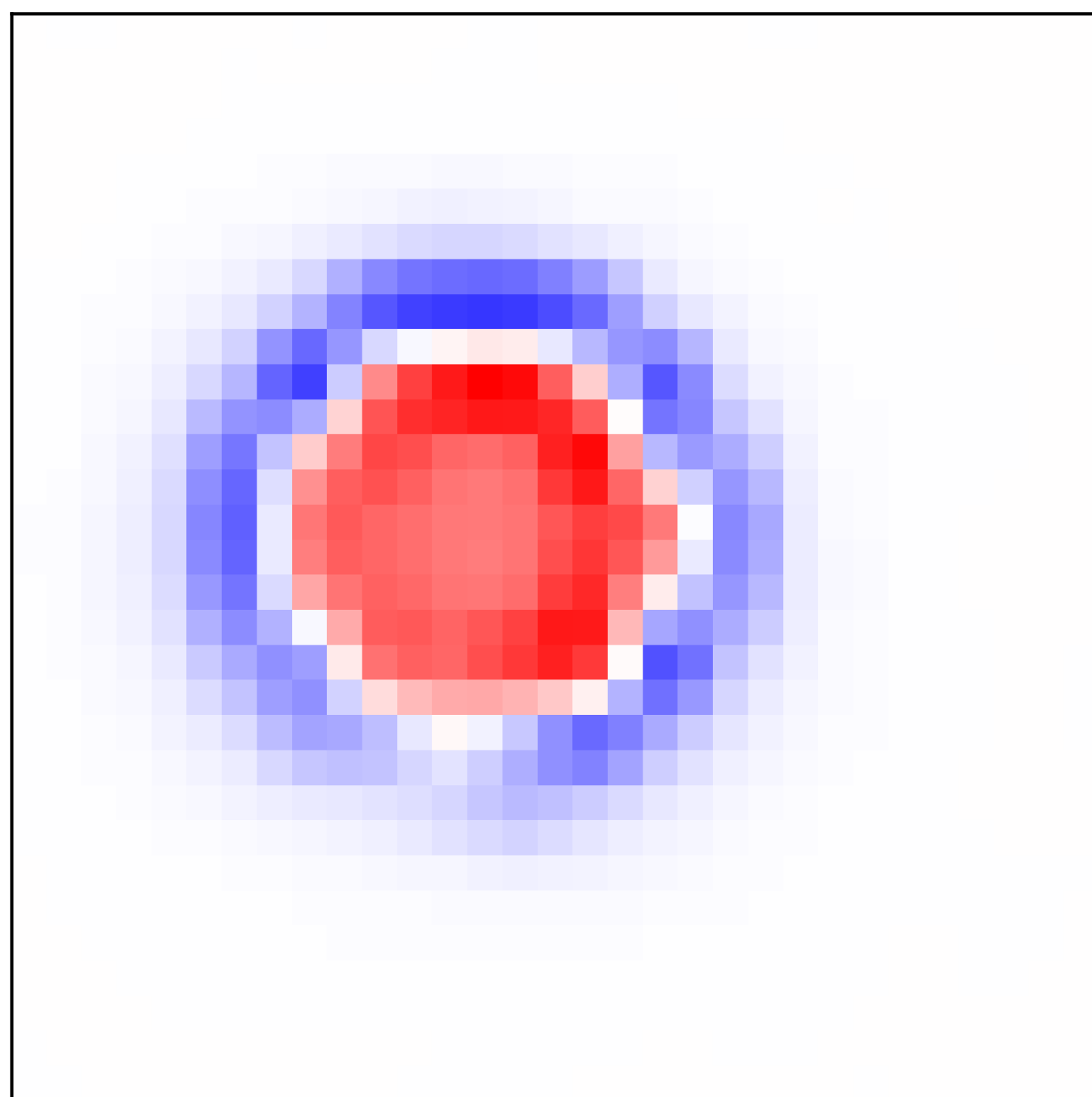
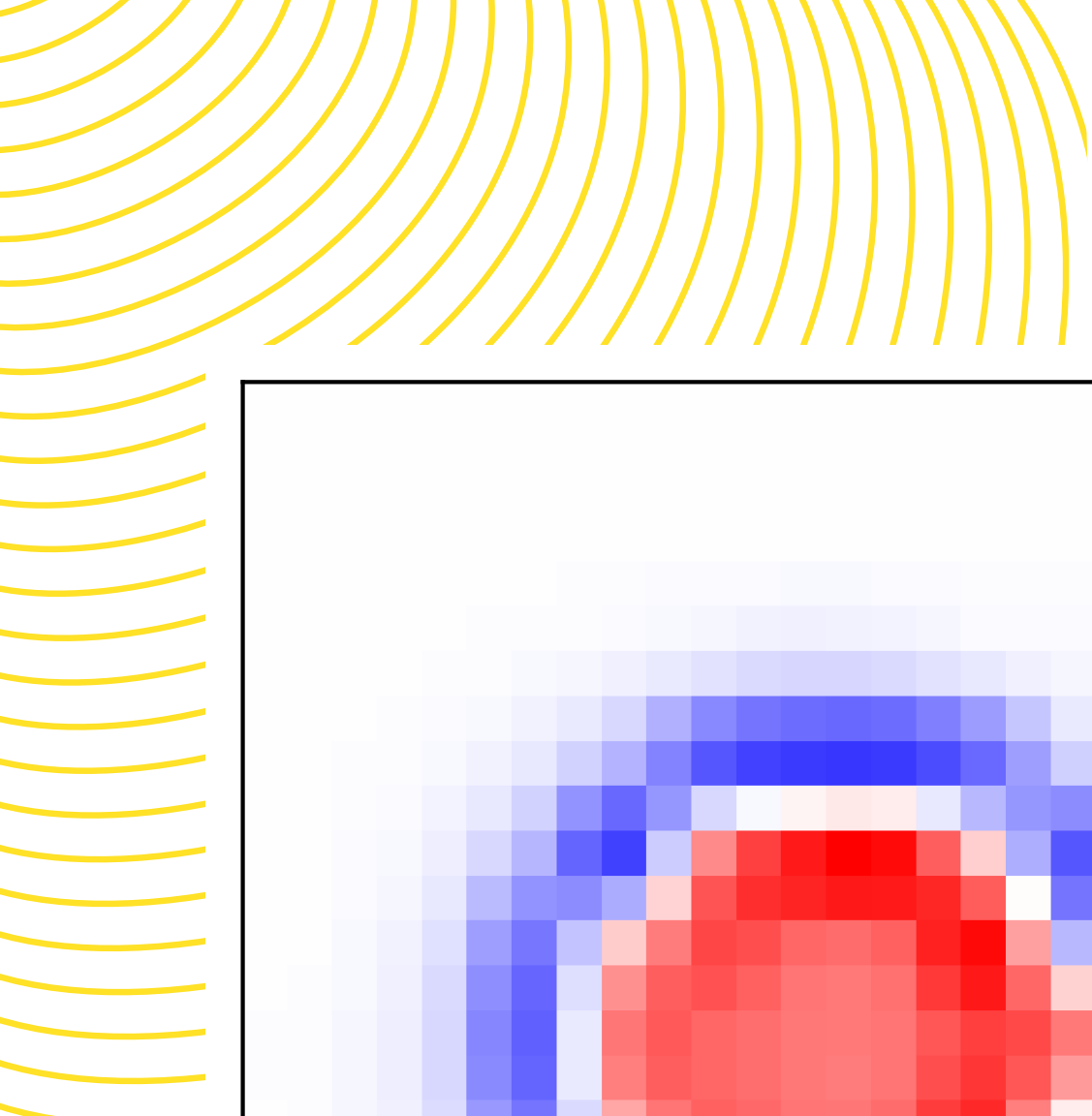
Final Device

Comprehensive fulfilment of all Design Goals

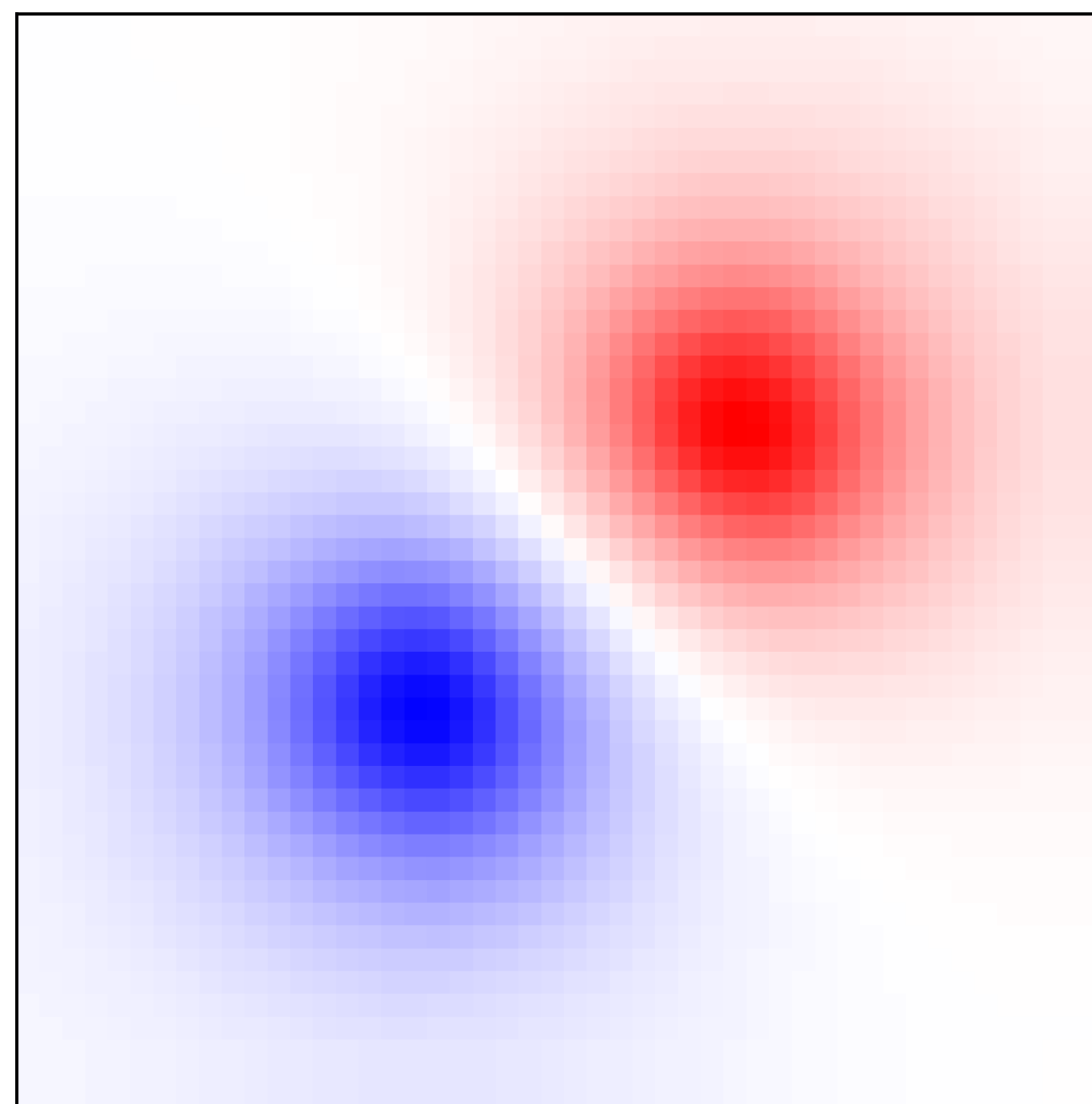


Linear constants and AC RMS Noise

—
Results



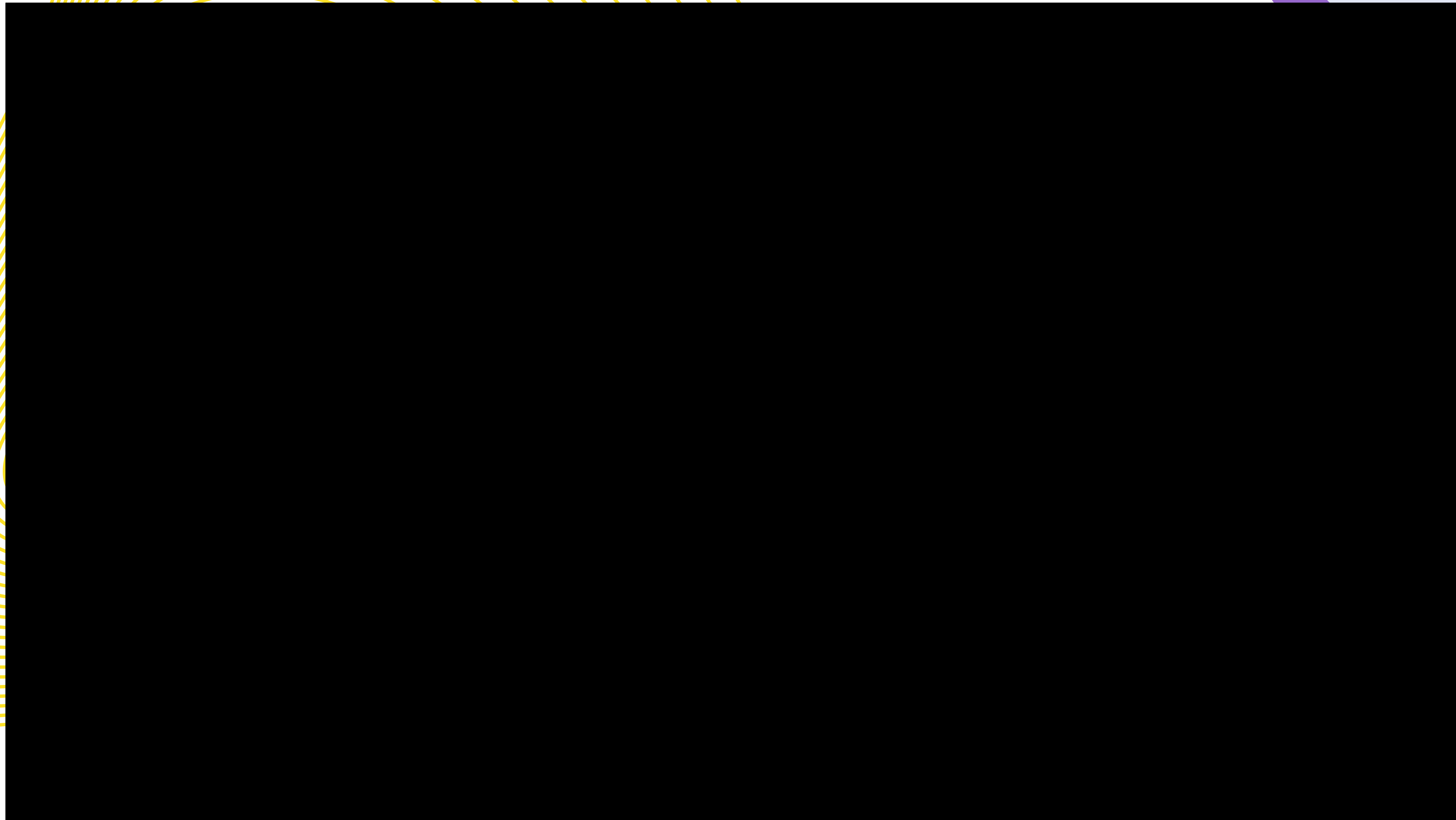
MagSafe Charger



Rare-Earth Bar Magnet

Static Imagery enhanced through **Bicubic Interpolation**

— Results



— What's Next?

- This work received a **Positive Reception** at the Symposium on Fusion Engineering, in Cambridge, MA; awarded UNSW nuclear innovation centre (UNIC) and Tyree foundation travel grant
- Immediate future priority: development of FPGA frontend to get full 20 kHz bandwidth with >40,000 SPS
- Will be used for SOUTH R&D, 2025–26
- From SOFE: collaboration with SMART
 - Coil alignment for second campaign
 - I will visit them in Seville in October
- Project scope is limited to small devices

The SMART Tokamak⁵

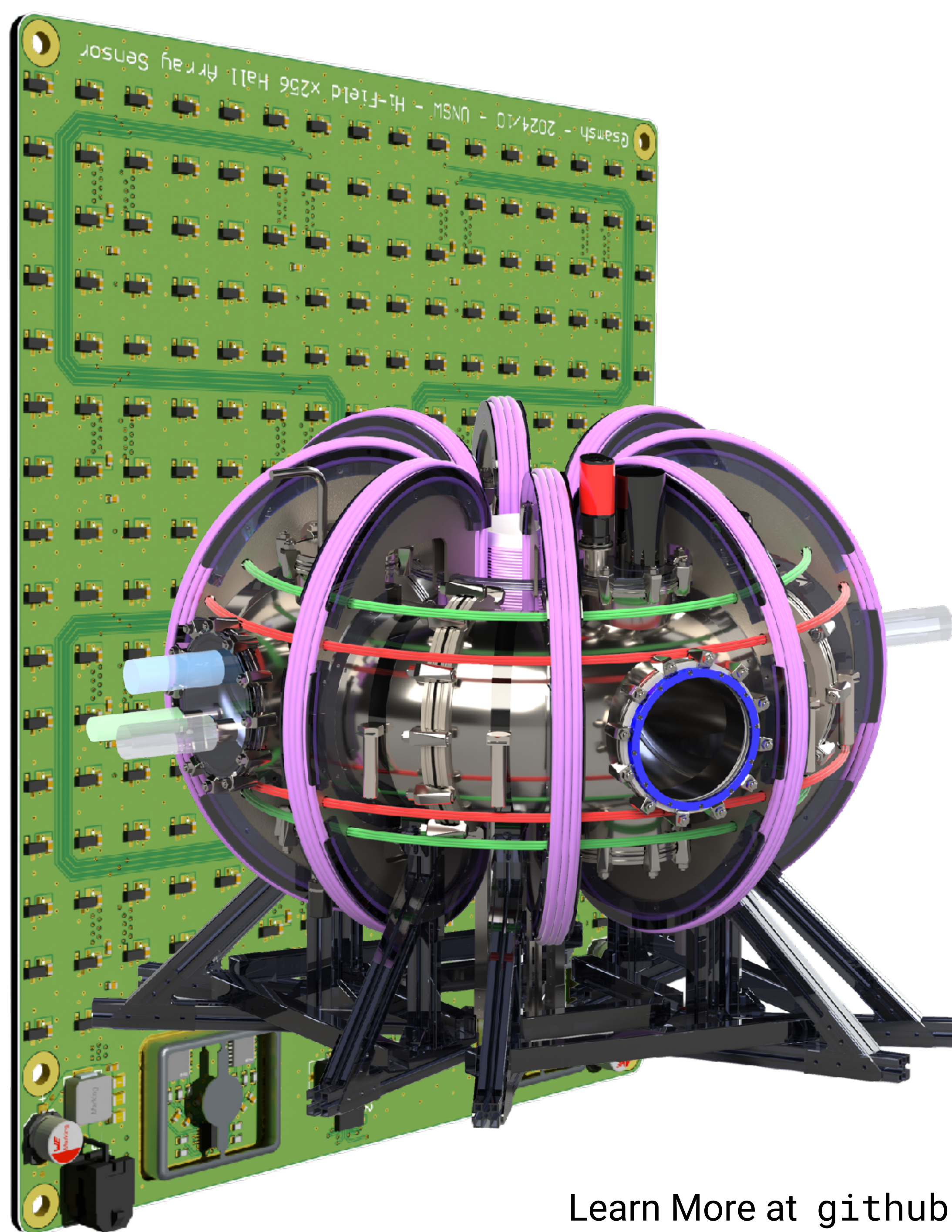
A collaboration between Seville and PPPL



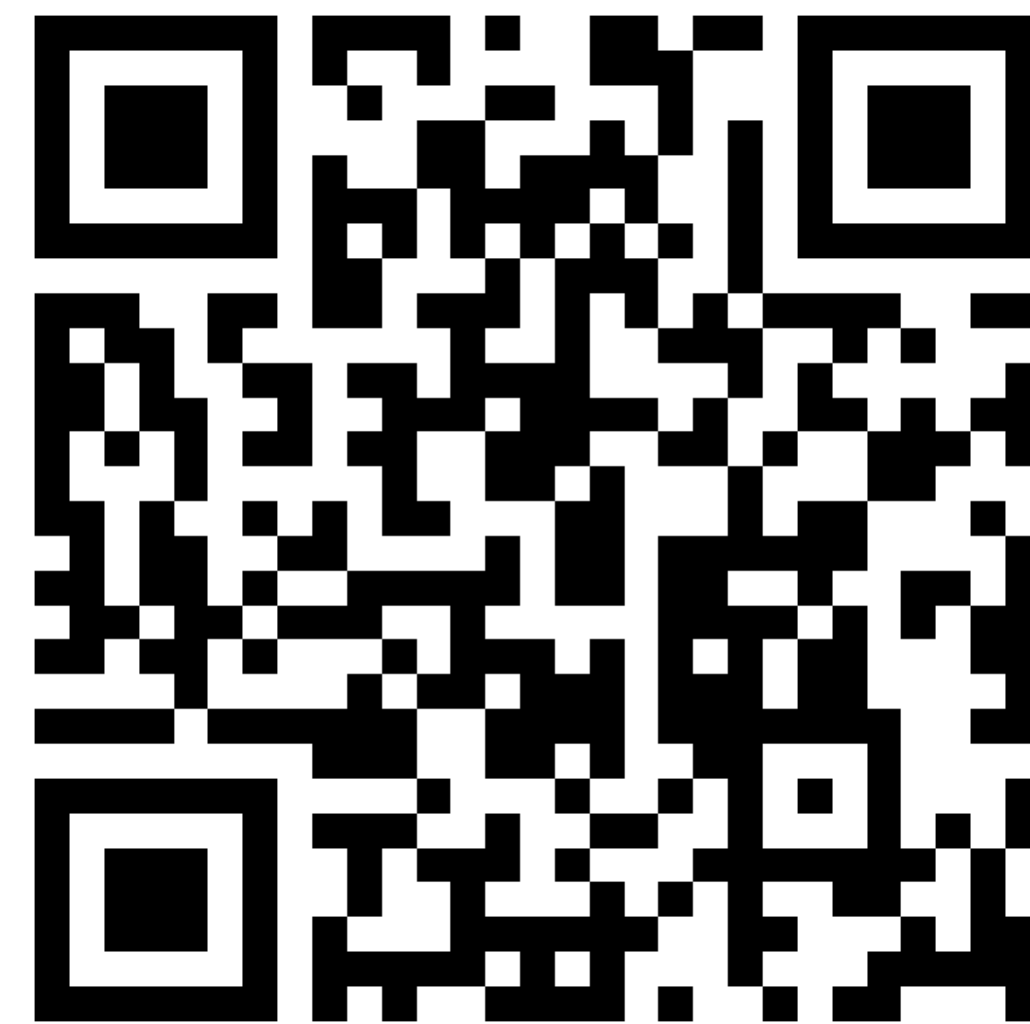
A **magnetic camera** designed to monitor Tokamak toroidal B fields,
designed to address the requirements of the upcoming SOUTH Tokamak:

- **20 kHz Bandwidth** achieved through and FPGA and multiple ADCs, or use slower real-time operation with a microcontroller
- **Dynamic range** exceeding of ± 150 mT
- **<1 LSB noise** floor facilitates an effective **sensitivity of ≈ 0.32 mT**
- Robust filtering regime to allow for **EMI resistance**
- **Pedagogical** and outreach potential
- Stay tuned for AtomCraft R&D and SMART commissioning!

Summary



**Thank
You!**



Learn More at github.com/Sam-js2/BETthesis or by scanning the QR code

Bibliography

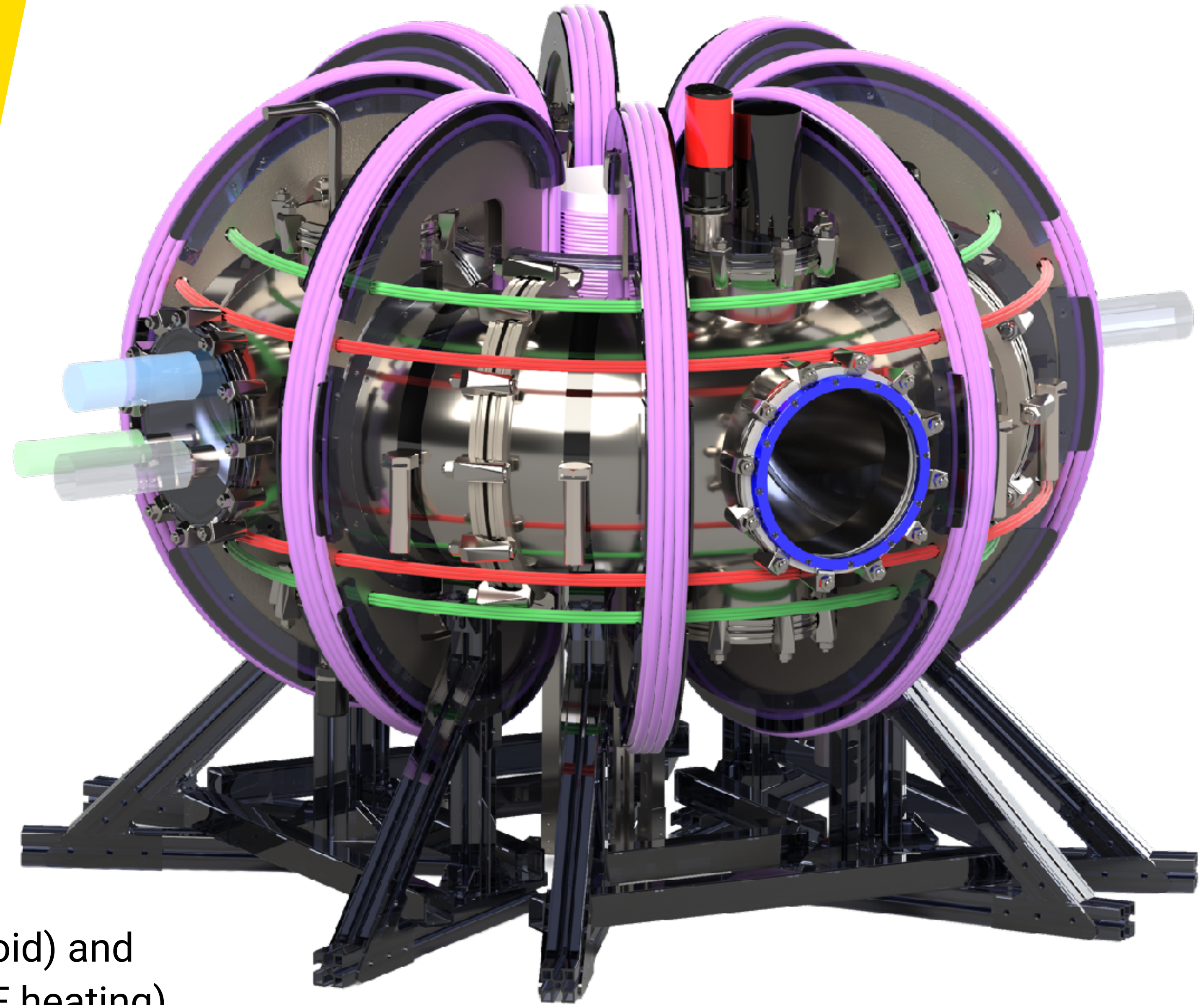
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Backup: SOUTH

Major Radius..... ~0.3 m
Minor Radius 30 cm
Peak Temperature 10 eV*
Plasma Current 3 kA
Toroidal on-axis Field 100 mT
Pulse Duration..... 100 ms

*Thats 120,000 degrees!

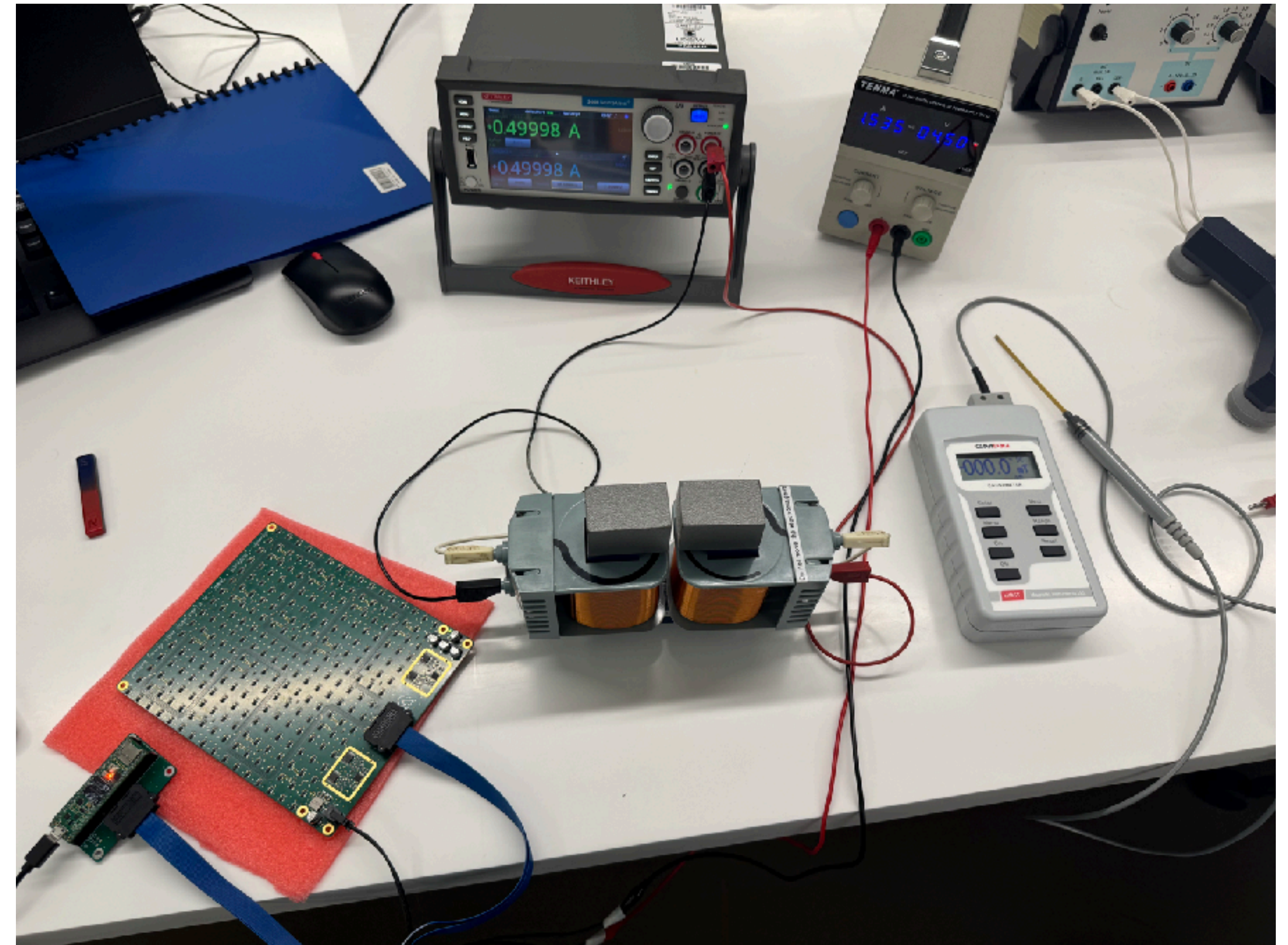
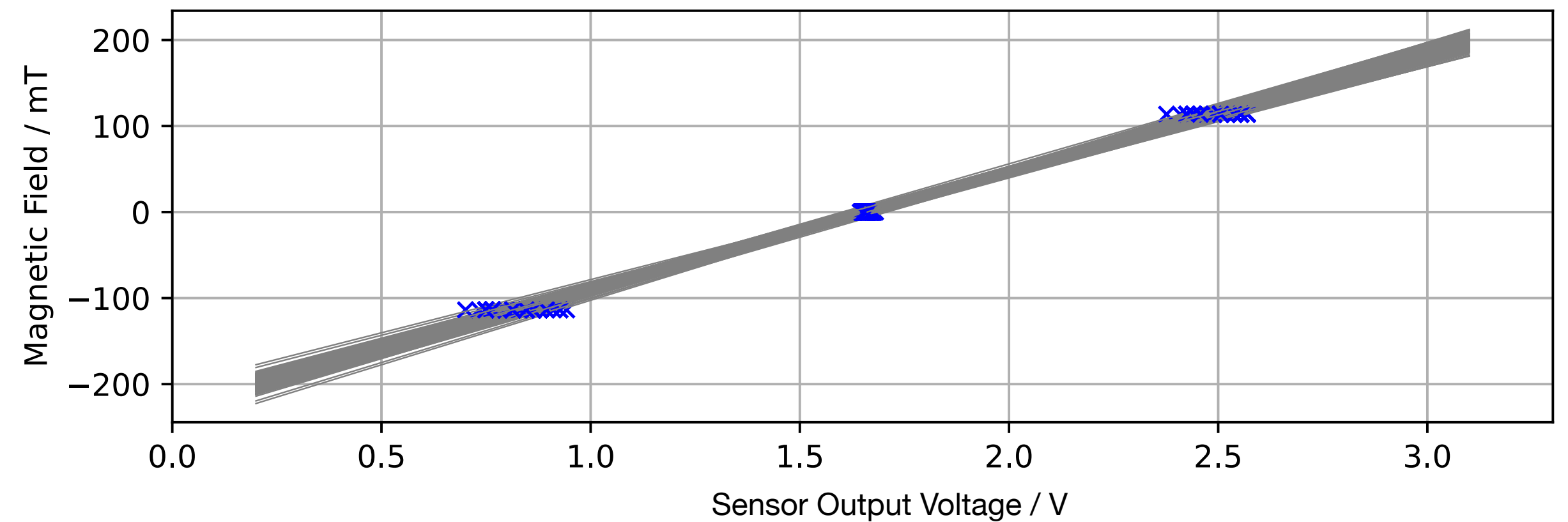
Ionisation with the help of **ohmic heating** (solenoid) and **electron cyclotron resonance heating** (ECRH–RF heating).



Backup: Calibration

Use **ferrite-core electromagnet** powered (extremely precisely) with a **source-meter**:

- ~115 mT field (<1% variations across surface), measured with gauss meter
- Measure aligned and anti aligned (i.e., +/–)
- Gather **lots** of datapoints
- Bin into histogram, take highest frequency bin
- Linear regression on +115/0/–115 mT
- Linearity is already guaranteed by manufacturer, just getting sensitivity



Backup: Digital Workings

